A-A-51358
28 April 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TONGS, LABORATORY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification NNN-T-580.

This commercial item description covers different types of laboratory tongs for the handling of laboratory apparatus.

Salient charascteristics:

Laboratory tongs shall meet the criteria as listed in Table I.

TABLE I Dimensions

Type	Tong Design	Jaw Style	Length (inches)	Material of Construction	Notes
A	Beaker	Smooth	13 ± 1/4	corrosion resisting steel	weight in palm design, asbestos sleeve
B	Crucible	Double bent	9 ± 1/8	low carbon nickel	scored jaw
C	Crucible	Double bent	10 ± 1	nickel plated cold rolled carbon steel	scored jaw
D	Flask	V-jaw	9 ± 1/8	corrosion resisting steel	weight in palm design
E	Crucible	Double bent	9 ± 1/8	corrosion resisting steel	serrated jaw
F	Crucible	Double bent	9 ± 1/8	nickel (80%) chromium (20%) Alloy	serrated jaw

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type A - Shall be fabricated from a corrosion resisting steel, beaker style design tongs incorporating the "weight in palm design". The tongs shall be 13 inches long. Shall be suitable for safe handling of different size beakers from 100-1500 ml capacities. Shall have smooth jaws covered with asbestos mittens.

Type B - Shall be fabricated from a corrosion resisting, low carbon-nickel steel, having a crucible-double bent design. The rivets fastening the tongs shall be a nominal 4-1/2 inches from the working tips. The overall length shall be 9 inches and the jaws shall be scored.

Type C - Shall be fabricated from a suitable cold rolled steel 5/16 ± 1/16 inches in diameter, having a crucible-double bent design. The jaws shall be serrated and the finger grips shall be oval shaped giving an efficient and comfortable grip. The tongs shall be 18 to 20 inches in length. Lot sizes shall be uniform in length. The tongs shall be nickel plated to resist corrosion.

Type D - Shall be fabricated from a corrosion resisting steel designed for holding flasks incorporating the "weight in palm design". The tongs shall be 9 inches in length with smooth "V" shaped jaws. The weld at the end of the tongs shall be as strong as the parent materials. All welds shall be clean and smooth. Tongs shall be capable of firmly gripping Erlenmeyer, Florence or any other rounded bottom flasks which accommodate rubber stoppers number 4-8 inclusive.

Type E - Shall be the same design as Type B using the double bent design and fabricated from corrosion resisting steel. The tongs shall be 9 inches in length and have serrated jaws.

Type F - Shall be the same design as Type B using the double bent design and fabricated from a nickel-chromium alloy (80%-20% respectively). The tongs shall have serrated jaws.

The hinge joint of the tongs shall be flattened in the area of the rivet to prevent the finger grips from shifting out of alignment. Rivets shall be spun (not hammered) in order to ensure free action without binding. Finger grips shall be oval shaped and shall give an efficient and comfortable grip. Laboratory tongs shall meet the requirements of design and materials of construction as specified in Table I. Tongs shall be capable of grasping the intended item for which it was designed. Tongs shall be repeatedly autoclavable and show no signs of rust, corrosion or deterioration. Tongs shall open and close in a uniform planer motion and shall not bend or twist under normal laboratory use.

Workmanship. The laboratory tong shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One type of tongs, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspections. Inspections, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level S-2, AQL 2.5, and sampling for tests (when applicable) shall be conducted at inspection level S-2, AQL 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

For information only.

The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6640-00-360-0013 TONGS, LABORATORY, Beaker, Type A

6640-00-360-0015 TONGS, LABORATORY, Crucible, Type B

6640-00-360-0018 TONGS, LABORATORY, Crucible, Type C

6640-00-377-6963 TONGS, LABORATORY, Flask, Type D

6640-00-444-8000 TONGS, LABORATORY, Crucible, Type E

6640-00-494-3779 TONGS, LABORATORY, Crucible, Type F

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Project No. 6640-1366

Location S3-9-10

U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1986 - 605-036/44871

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY



NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
Attn: DPSC-ATTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51358	Tongs, Laboratory

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.